Arya Honraopatil

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

- Natural Language Processing (NLP)
- Computational Storytelling
- Large Language Models (LLMs) and Agentic AI
- Human-AI Collaboration & Affective Computing

EDUCATION

Doctor of Philosophy, Computer Science — Aug. 2024 – Present
University of Maryland, Baltimore County (UMBC) — *Baltimore, MD*
– Advisor: Prof. Lara J. Martin

Master of Science, Computer Science — Aug. 2022 – May 2024
University of Maryland, Baltimore County (UMBC) — *Baltimore, MD*

Bachelor of Engineering, Computer Engineering — Aug. 2017 – May 2021
University of Pune, India — *Pune, India*

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

P. Delafuente, **A. Honraopatil**, and L. J. Martin. *"Does Reasoning Help LLM Agents Play Dungeons and Dragons? A Prompt Engineering Experiment"* at the Fifth Wordplay: When Language Meets Games Workshop at EMNLP, Suzhou, China, Nov. 2025. wordplay-workshop.github.io/pdfs/29.pdf, arxiv.org:2510.18112

A. Honraopatil, S.Vallurupalli, and L. J. Martin. *"Shaping Perception of Emotional Storytelling with Synthesized Speech."* Presented at the Mid-Atlantic Student Colloquium on Speech, Language and Learning (MASC-SLL 2025), Pennsylvania State University, 2025.

EXPERIENCE

Graduate Research Assistant — Jan. 2025 – May 2026
Language Aid and Representation AI (LARA) Lab, UMBC — *Baltimore, MD*

Graduate Research Assistant — Jan. 2023 – Aug. 2023
Lab for Informatics for Human Flourishing, UMBC — *Baltimore, MD*

Software Development Engineer — Jul. 2021 – Jul. 2022
Principal Global Services — *Pune, India*

Research & Development Intern — Sep. 2020 – Jun. 2021
PTC Inc. — *Pune, India*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Teaching Assistant — Aug. 2024 – Present
University of Maryland, Baltimore County — *Baltimore, MD*

- **Fall 2026** – Neurosymbolic Text Generation — *Prof. Lara J. Martin*
- **Fall 2026** – Computer Organization and Assembly Language Programming — *Prof. RJ Joyce*
- **Summer 2026** – Introduction to Data Science — *Prof. Jeremy Dixon*
- **Fall 2024** – Computer Science Programming — *Prof. Jeremy Dixon*
- **Summer 2024** – Social and Ethical Issues in Information Technology — *Prof. Jeremy Dixon*

Orientation Advisor — May 2023 – Present
University of Maryland, Baltimore County — *Baltimore, MD*

Graduate Assistant — Aug. 2023 - May 2024
University of Maryland, Baltimore County — *Baltimore, MD*

- **Fall 2023 & Spring 2024** – Discrete Structures — *Prof. Yang Chen*

Mathematics Instructor Jul. 2018 - Feb. 2020
Spectrum Education *Pune, India*

Robotics Instructor Aug. 2020 - Jul. 2022
Bhumi (non-profit) *Pune, India*

AWARDS

- **Travel Grant**, AAAI awarded $833 to attend AIIDE 2026 *(based on acceptance to the Doctoral Consortium)*
- **Travel Grant**, UMBC GSA awarded $900 to attend AIIDE 2026
- **Best Poster Award**, CSEE Research Day 2025, UMBC
- **Travel Grant**, UMBC GSA awarded $750 to attend IEEE ICSC 2024
- **Earth Award**, Bhumi (Non-profit) for work done as a Project Lead for Robotics Team for AY 2021-22
- **Best Outgoing Student**, St. Mira's School, Pune, for AY 2014-15

TALKS & PRESENTATIONS

- **Wrong, Then Less Wrong: Lessons from a PhD in NLP and Storytelling** Jul. 2026
  Talk, iAAMCS (Institute for African American Mentoring in Computing Sciences)

- **Cooperative Roleplaying with Affective, Symbolic Representation-Guided Deep Reinforcement Learning (Accepted)** Nov. 2026
  Doctoral Consortium Presentation, AIIDE 2026 (The 22nd AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence and Interactive Digital Entertainment)

ACADEMIC SERVICE

- **Volunteer**: Wordplay workshop at EMNLP 2025
- **Reviewer**: DocInsights Workshop at EMNLP 2026, ACL ARR Jan 2026, AIIDE 2026, Wordplay Workshop at EMNLP 2025, INLG 2025, AIIDE 2025, INT Workshop at AIIDE 2025, 2024
- **Secondary Reviewer**: ACL ARR March 2025, INLG 2024

LEADERSHIP

- **Graduate Student Association (GSA)**:
  AY 2026-27: *Member*, Grants Review Panel
  AY 2025-26: *Chair*, Graduate Experience, Achievements & Research Successes (GEARS)
  AY 2024-25: *Member*, Equity of Funds
  AY 2023-24: *Historian*, GEARS; *Student Affairs Senator*
- **Graduate Assistant Representative**, GA Life-cycle Working Group at UMBC for Spring 2026
- **Graduate Student Representative**, IT Steering Committee, UMBC for AY 2023-24
- **Project Lead**, Robotics Team, Bhumi (Non-profit), Pune for AY 2021-22
- **Technical Head**, Department of Computer Engineering, Sinhgad Academy of Engineering for AY 2020-21
- **Member**, Rotaract Club of Sinhgad Academy of Engineering for AY 2020-21
- **Co-Chief Editor**, St. Mira's School Magazine for AY 2013-14 & 2014-15